



IN CONTEXT

GENRE
Drama

DIRECTOR
Glauber Rocha

WRITER
Glauber Rocha

STARS
Geraldo Del Rey, Yoná Magalhães, Maurício do Valle, Lidio Silva

BEFORE
1962 In Rocha's debut feature, *Barravento*, a man struggles to rid his home village of the reactionary mysticism he thinks is holding it back.

AFTER
1966 Italian director Sergio Corbucci's *Django*, a bleakly savage spaghetti Western, owes a clear debt to Rocha.

1970 Chilean director Alejandro Jodorowsky's *El Topo* features a gunslinger on a transformative journey across the desert.

THERE'S GOLD IN THE SEA BEYOND

BLACK GOD, WHITE DEVIL / 1964

Director Glauber Rocha once said that "Everybody wants to kill Glauber Rocha. They did not forgive me for making *Black God, White Devil* at the age of 23." It was not simply his precociousness or lack of humility that put his life in jeopardy; a fierce pioneer of social realism, Rocha saw movies as a tool of change and an integral part of the working man's struggle. Indeed, shortly before his movie was released in his native Brazil, a coup ushered in a military government whose actions later drove him into self-imposed exile.

Committed cinema

Rocha despised Hollywood, and it shows: it's hard to believe that this abrasive movie was released in the same year as *Mary Poppins*. Like his debut, *Barravento*, it is more concerned with ideas than action or character, and it continues the earlier movie's exploration of religion.

Sebastião (Lidio Silva), a preacher, is rallying the poor of the *sertão*, the barren outback of north



This movie is Glauber Rocha's fictionalized account of the adventures of real-life bounty hunter Antonio das Mortes.

Brazil. A humble ranch hand named Manuel (Geraldo Del Rey) believes the preacher is the incarnation of Saint Sebastian, but his wife, Rosa (Yoná Magalhães), is more sceptical and frequently challenges Manuel's belief in the man he follows.

Manuel tries to improve his and Rosa's lot in life by selling his cattle to his boss, but several die on the way to market, and the boss refuses to pay. In a fury, Manuel kills his boss with a machete, and he and Rosa go on the run, following the charismatic and increasingly powerful Sebastião, the "black god," who promises